

DROOLMAAL

RM 47

The RM47 Tourbillon is Richard Mille's latest creation which pays tribute to Japanese culture and the samurai of old. This is an intricately crafted timepiece, and was made in partnership with two-time Formula 1 champion, Fernando Alonso. The watch took Richard Mille almost four years to complete, from the ideation phase to the creation of the final product. A close look at the skeletonized dial of the watch reveals a beautifully crafted samurai, paying homage to the Bushido spirit and one of the most iconic moments from Japanese history – the Forty-Seven Ronin incident, where a group of samurai took revenge for the death of their master, Asano Naganori. Hence, the 47 in RM47 in case you were wondering.



The RM47 Tourbillon features gold samurai armour, with a pair of swords on the dial which has been hand-crafted and painted. The engraving work on each piece took upwards of 16 hours, followed by nine hours of hand painting!

The watch uses a specially designed calibre in order to accommodate the handcrafted samurai suit. The tourbillon bears the Asano clan's Kamon or crest of two crossed falcon feathers at the six o'clock position. The winding crown features the maple leaf, which is also a Japanese symbol. The baseplate and skeletonized bridges are made out of Grade 5 titanium. The movement is placed inside an open or tonneau-shaped case, and features a three-piece build. Considering the amount of work that goes into one of these pieces, it doesn't come as a surprise that there are only 75 pieces of this limited edition timepiece. The RM47 is priced at approximately \$1 million per piece.

Ulysse Nardin
Freak S

Revealed at the Watches and Wonders 2022 trade show, the Ulysse Nardin Freak S is a new iteration of the original Ulysse Nardin Freak, which was the first timepiece to use silicon parts in its movement. Additionally, it was a jaw dropping watch to look at, with intricate construction and complex mechanicals. The 2022 Freak S takes that to the next level, with a dial that is designed to look like a spaceship soaring through space with stars smattered across the background. The Freak S stays in line with the original Freak, and does not have a conventional dial, hands and crown.

The Freak S is made out of 18k rose gold and black titanium. It's also water resistant up to 30 metres. Time adjustment is done via the top bezel, which can be rotated, but is otherwise locked in place via a small tab located at the 6 o'clock mark. You can manually wind the mainspring thanks to a caseback crown. Inside the case, you've got a calibre UN-251 automatic movement, which has two balance systems operating at a frequency of 2.5Hz. The movement has a power reserve of 72 hours thanks to this. You've also got Ulysse Nardin's proprietary "Grinder" winding system which debuted on the Freak Vision a few years prior. This system utilises the movement of the wrist itself to self-wind the mainspring, rather than a conventional oscillator.

Speaking of the Oscillators, they're inclined at 20 degrees, and placed in two different planes. The running train and the regulation system are crafted in such a way that the whole setup appears like a spacecraft. There are only 75 pieces of the Freak S, each priced at \$137,200.